

**THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS**

Shared Value and the Humanity of Leadership

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructors: Dr. Cecilia Leung
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Consultation times: By email appointment

Co-requisites: N/A
Mutually exclusive: N/A

Reference Books:

Cheng, B. H. (2023). *The Return on Kindness: How Kind Leadership Wins Talent, Earns Loyalty, and Builds Successful Companies*. Penguin Random House.
Greenleaf, R. K. (1977). *Servant leadership: A journey into the nature of legitimate power and greatness*. Paulist Press.
Virdee, H. K. (2024). *Flourish: Unleash potential, inspire excellence*. Live Beyond Bounds.

The following programming languages are used in this course: English

COURSE DESCRIPTION

Current measurements of organizational success are closely related to business and economic success. As a result, leadership courses have been focused on enhancing leaders' business performance, with minimal attention paid to developing skills that sustain trusting relationships with organizations' most important resource – people. Further, no conventional leadership style prioritizes people. Yet, if technology and AI are the future, humanity becomes the USP of leadership.

The humanity of leadership creates shared value by bridging business and the needs of society. This requires that leaders carry a strong understanding of their company's implicit purpose and what social needs the company can serve, such as addressing the broader needs of underrepresented customer and community groups. The ability to design and implement shared value models, tackle new and complex challenges, and a willingness to take risks are key characteristics of a shared value leader.

This course will introduce you to a leadership approach that is human, first. It will cover topics surrounding how to develop and maintain trust between you as leader and your people and how to lead teams and organizations built to last with empathy, compassion, and humility. The aim is to provide students with the awareness, understanding, and tools to lead with humanity. To achieve this, we will consider how companies with leaders adopting this style of leadership have seen higher returns on business outcomes, and help you develop the skills that lay the foundation for a human style of leadership.

This course will provide frameworks and principles based on academic research from a range of fields, such as social psychology, management, and coaching, and intersect management consulting for students to apply to their understanding to the business world. Students will gain a deep understanding of how to lead with humanity through an interactive and practical course structured to prepare you to be impactful leaders.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

The course aims to:

- Develop students' awareness and understanding of leadership issues facing companies today
- Provide students with relevant human-focused leadership frameworks to analyze, evaluate, and apply
- Expose students to first-hand experiential learning on foundations of the humanity of leadership
- Enable students to develop and practice skills in this leadership approach that can be applied immediately

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the programme discipline			
PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge			
PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership			
PLO4: Developing global outlook			
PLO5: Mastering communication skills			
COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES			
Course Learning Outcomes		Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes	
CLO1: Develop fundamental understanding of humanity of leadership frameworks		PLO1, 2, 4	
CLO2: Experiential learning on the humanity of leadership through participation in various simulations, fast consulting exercises, and workshops		PLO1, 2, 3	
CLO3: Integrate and apply foundational concepts, frameworks and learning to formulate an analysis and critical assessment of organizational leaders and self as leader		PLO1, 2, 3, 4, 5	
CLO4: Enhance knowledge and understanding of the humanity of leadership across a wide variety of contexts and situations		PLO1, 2, 4, 5	
COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES			
Course Teaching and Learning Activities		Expected contact hour	Study Load (% of study)
T&L1. Interactive lectures and discussions		30	20%
T&L2. Experiential learning and reflection		20	15%
T&L3. Group project research, analysis, and presentation		50	40%
T&L4. Lecture preparation and self-study		20	25%
Total		120	100%
Assessment Methods			
Brief Description (Optional)		Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. Attendance and participation	Individual contribution	25%	CLO1, 3, 4
A2. Individual assignment	Experiential learning	25%	CLO2, 3, 4
A3. Group project presentation	Group consulting project	50%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
Total		100%	
STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT			
Course Grade Descriptors			
A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions professionally • High participation in discussions • Present arguments that have an element of originality • Excellent performance in assignments		
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Handling questions in a logical way • Good participation in discussions • Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and readings • Good performance in assignments		
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved • Fairly address questions • Some participation in discussions • Present arguments in a well-structured manner • Acceptable performance in assignments		

D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved • Barely address questions • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner • Marginally acceptable performance in assignments
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Unable or unwilling to handle questions • Minimal or no participation in discussions • Present arguments poorly • Poor performance in assignments
Assessment Rubrics for Participation and Individual Assignment	
A+, A, A-	• High participation in in-class activities, discussions, and assignments • Always attend in-class lectures and discussions with no disruptive behaviors • Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge • Strong demonstration of quality responses, contributions, and reflection
B+, B, B-	• Moderate participation in in-class activities, discussions, and assignments • Moderate attendance in lectures and discussions with minimal disruptive behaviors • Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge • Good demonstration of quality responses, contributions, and reflection
C+, C, C-	• Some participation in in-class activities, discussions, and assignments • Some attendance in lectures and discussions with some disruptive behaviors • Demonstrate a fair understanding of relevant knowledge • Fair demonstration of responses, contributions, and reflection
D+, D	• Minimal or no participation in in-class activities, discussions, and assignments • Minimal attendance in lectures and discussions with some disruptive behaviors • Demonstrate a marginally acceptable understanding of relevant knowledge • Minimal demonstration of responses, contributions, and reflection
F	• Poor or lacking participation in in-class activities, discussions, and assignments • Insufficient attendance in lectures and discussions with disruptive behaviors • Lacking in understanding of relevant knowledge
Assessment Rubrics for Group Project Presentation	
A+, A, A-	• Demonstrate a strong understanding of relevant knowledge • Achieve a standard of excellent performance with strong critical analysis • Solid presentation skills – professional, well-rehearsed, exciting, strong visual aids
B+, B, B-	• Demonstrate a good understanding of relevant knowledge • Achieve a standard of good performance with good critical analysis • Good presentation skills – most members professional, rehearsed, good visual aids
C+, C, C-	• Demonstrate a basic understanding of relevant knowledge • Achieve a standard of fair performance with some evidence of critical analysis • Fair presentation skills – some professionalism, fair visual aids
D+, D	• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of relevant knowledge • Achieve a standard of marginally acceptable performance lacking in critical analysis • Marginally acceptable presentation skills
F	• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved • Present arguments poorly • Inadequate presentation skills – lacks professionalism, not rehearsed, not exciting, poor visual aids
COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE	
Lecture 1: The fall of current leadership practices Lecture 2: The need to re-humanise workplace Lecture 3: Reframing greatness & leadership practices Lecture 4: Social value and leadership Lecture 5: Frameworks for leading with humanity Lecture 6: Growing the serving hearts of leaders Lecture 7: Putting human-first leadership to work through coaching Lecture 8: How leading with humanity contributes to thriving corporate cultures Lecture 9: Testing the validity of leading with humanity Lecture 10: Putting human-first leadership to work through consulting - Final group presentations	

Attendance and Participation (25%):

You are expected to attend all class meetings, to be on time, and to stay for the duration of the class. All class meetings will involve in-class activities, fast-consulting exercises, group discussions, and guest speakers' experience sharing. It is imperative that you contribute to these learning opportunities. The more you actively participate, the more interesting the class will be and the more learning that will take place for you and your peers.

Individual Assignment (25%):

This assignment is an experiential learning component designed to help students practice human-centered leadership in real contexts. Rather than studying leadership as theory alone, students will observe human dynamics within a group they belong to, take at least one intentional leadership action that addresses a real human tension, and reflect on the impact of that action over time. The focus is not on formal authority or dramatic outcomes, but on developing awareness, responsibility, and relational maturity. Through a structured Notice–Act–Reflect process, students integrate course concepts with lived experience and demonstrate how their understanding of leadership evolves across the course. Detail will be provided at the first class.

Group Consulting Project Presentation (50%):

This is a consulting group project in which your group represents a top-rated consulting firm. Bringing humanity into the workplace becomes a high priority for corporations. Many are trying to change their profit / performance focus to putting their employees as the top priority instead. As part of this culture shift, corporations are redesigning their leadership training and development programs. Your group has just been hired by a company to assist in this endeavor.

Each group will choose a real-life company and design a change program to help them to develop a human-centered leadership approach. Your group should prepare a presentation of your deliverable to the CEO and senior executives (Guest – Senior Executive & Instructor) to explain your proposal.

You may use any form of presentation you wish to make it interesting. Each member of the group must speak in the presentation, length of presentation is TBD based on number of groups. Each group will submit an additional report to supplement their presentation. Groups will be formed during the first class, and more details on the group project presentation will be provided during the first class.

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

To be announced on Moodle.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

- ☐ Online response via Moodle site
- ☐ Others: SFTL (please specify)

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

An orderly, safe, and supportive learning environment is extremely important.

Academic dishonesty is a behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit. It includes, but is not necessarily limited to:

a. Plagiarism: The representation of someone else's ideas as if they are one's own. Where the arguments, data, designs, etc., of someone else are being used in a paper, report, oral presentation, or similar academic project, this fact must be made explicitly clear by citing the appropriate references. The references must fully indicate the extent to which any parts of the project are not one's own work. Paraphrasing of someone else's ideas is still using someone else's ideas, and must be acknowledged.

b. Unauthorized Collaboration on Out-of-Class Projects: The representation of work as solely one's own when in fact it is the result of a joint effort.

Incident(s) of academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated. Any such dishonesty will automatically result in an F grade. The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism on <http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism/>.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

No late assignment will be accepted.
Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.